Vera Neplenbroek

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Personal Profile

I am a third year PhD student at the University of Amsterdam where I research the safety and biases of conversational AI models. In my published works I have investigated detection and mitigation of stereotypes in different languages, as well as inferences models make about their users' sociodemographic characteristics.

Education

2023 - present	PhD on Safety of Conversational AI Advisors: Prof. Dr. Raquel Fernández & Dr. Arianna Bisazza	**ILLC, University of Amsterdam**
2021 - 2023	Master's Degree (Artificial Intelligence) GPA: 9/10	**University of Amsterdam**
2018 - 2021	Bachelor's Degree (Liberal Arts and Sciences) GPA: 3.93/4.0	**Amsterdam University College**

Work Experience

Data Scientist Intern Jan 2020 - Jun 2021

Machine Learning Programs, Amsterdam

- Training machine learning models for premium prediction and propensity to claim.
- Incorporating domain knowledge on car insurance.
- Writing literate programming documents analyzing data sets, and model performance.
- Supervising groups of undergraduates during their one month internship projects.

Teaching Experience

Supervision

- Master thesis on 'Investigating the Effects of Code-Switching on Toxicity and Biases Exhibited by Large Language Models'.
- Internship on 'Explainable Customer Call Classification with Text Bottleneck Models', which led to an ACL Industry track publication.

Teaching Assistant

- 4 courses in the MSc AI program: Natural Language Processing 1 (4x), Advanced Topics in Computational Semantics (2x), Knowledge Representation and Reasoning, and Automated Planning.
- Teaching tutorial sessions, assisting students with their assignments, and answering their questions.
- Giving (guest) lectures on NLP course topics as well as my own research on LLM biases and safety.
- Designing, supervising and grading of (group) assignments and exams.

Talks & Presentations

- **EvalEval Workshop**
  July 2026 San Diego
- **Deep Tech Day**
  January 2026 Amsterdam

– **NatWest Group DS Seminar Series**
August 2025 Online
– **HumanCLAIM Workshop**
March 2025 Göttingen
– **CL Group Seminar**
March 2025, March 2026 Groningen
– **Workshop on New Perspectives on Bias and Discrimination in Language Technology**
Nov 2024 Amsterdam

Service

– **Reviewing**
ARR, NLP4PI 2026, ECIR 2026 - IR-for-Good track, EACL SRW 2026, BlackboxNLP 2025 & 2026, GeBNLP 2025, CLIN 34
– **Volunteering**
COLM 2024, ACL 2025
– **Organizing**
  – Co-organizing the next edition of the Gender Bias in NLP (GeBNLP) workshop.
  – Co-organizing the CLS (Computational Linguistics Seminar) of the University of Amsterdam.
  – Co-organizing NLPitch (Series of talks about ongoing and published work by NLP PhD students at the ILLC).

Awards

– Outstanding Reviewer award ARR July 2025

Selected Publications

[1] Vera Neplenbroek et al. "MBBQ: A Dataset for Cross-Lingual Comparison of Stereotypes in Generative LLMs". In: *First Conference on Language Modeling*. 2024. URL: https://openreview.net/forum?id=X9yV4lFHt4.

[2] Vera Neplenbroek et al. "Cross-Lingual Transfer of Debiasing and Detoxification in Multilingual LLMs: An Extensive Investigation". In: *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2025*. Ed. by Wanxiang Che et al. Vienna, Austria: Association for Computational Linguistics, July 2025, pp. 2805–2830. ISBN: 979-8-89176-256-5. URL: https://aclanthology.org/2025.findings-acl.145/.

[3] Vera Neplenbroek et al. "Reading Between the Prompts: How Stereotypes Shape LLM's Implicit Personalization". In: *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing*. Ed. by Christos Christodoulopoulos et al. Suzhou, China: Association for Computational Linguistics, Nov. 2025, pp. 20367–20400. ISBN: 979-8-89176-332-6. DOI: 10.18653/v1/2025.emnlp-main.1029. URL: https://aclanthology.org/2025.emnlp-main.1029/.

[4] Franziska Weeber et al. "One Persona, Many Cues, Different Results: How Sociodemographic Cues Impact LLM Personalization". In: *Proceedings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 1: Long Papers)*. Ed. by Maria Liakata et al. San Diego, California, United States: Association for Computational Linguistics, July 2026, pp. 44892–44921. ISBN: 979-8-89176-390-6. DOI: 10.18653/v1/2026.acl-long.2079. URL: https://aclanthology.org/2026.acl-long.2079/.

[5] Vera Neplenbroek et al. *Topics as Proxies for Sociodemographics: How Conversational Context Affects LLM Answers*. 2026. arXiv: 2606.02776 [cs.CL]. URL: https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.02776.